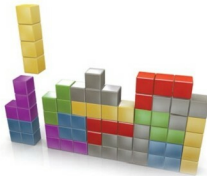


Playing Games on GNU Emacs



In this article in the GNU Emacs series, let's learn how to play games and try out some software for fun.

Ten games that are available and can be played easily in GNU Emacs are listed and discussed in this article. We start with the most popular one, Tetris.

1. Tetris

Tetris is available in GNU Emacs and you can launch it using *M-x tetris*. The 'Up' arrow key can be used to spin the tile, while the space key can quickly drop the tile. You can pause the game by pressing the 'p' key. At the end of the game, a score is displayed in a buffer. For example:

```
112 shakthi shakthi <author@shakthimaan.com> Mon Nov 2
21:12:04 2015
52 shakthi Shakthi Kannan <author@shakthimaan.com> Mon Nov
2 15:24:43 2015
11 shakthi shakthi <author@shakthimaan.com> Mon Nov 2
15:29:39 2015
```

A screenshot of Tetris in GNU Emacs is shown in Figure 1.

2. Pong

You can play Ping Pong in GNU Emacs with two players, using *M-x pong*. One player can use the 'Up' and 'Down' arrow keys, and the second player can use the number keys – '4' and '6', respectively. Each paddle is represented by three square tiles. If the ball hits the edge of the paddle, it changes its direction. You can use the 'p' key to pause the game. A live score is displayed during the game. A screenshot of Pong is shown in Figure 2.

3. Doctor

GNU Emacs comes with a psychotherapist with whom you can chat. Simply type *M-x doctor* and it will start a session with the therapist. After you type in your statement, you need to hit *Enter* twice, and the therapist will reply. It will usually ask you another question, and you can continue to chat with the doctor. An example of a session is given below:

```
I am the psychotherapist. Please, describe your problems.
Each time you are finished talking, type RET twice.
Hi How do you do? What brings you to see me?
I am trying to talk to the doctor. Why do you say you are
trying to talk to the doctor?
I want to share this transcript with my readers.
```

What makes you believe you might want to share this transcript with your readers?

I can, from GNU Emacs, copy this text and paste it in my article

Emacs? Hah! I would appreciate it if you would continue.

I am looking forward to watching today's cricket match that India is playing.

Is it because India is playing that you came to me?

Yes, who do you think will win?

Earlier you said you would like to share this transcript with your readers?

Yes, I am still going to do that.

Can you elaborate on that?

I am writing a GNU Emacs series for the OSFY magazine.

Are you sure?

Yes, I have been writing for the past few months.

Maybe your life has something to do with this.

I want people to learn and use GNU Emacs to improve their productivity.

Are you sure about that?

Absolutely!

Perhaps you could continue.

4. Bubbles

The objective of the Bubbles game is to remove a series of connected bubbles in the fewest number of moves. The game can be started using *M-x bubbles*. As you move through the grid of bubbles, the connected bubbles with the same colour get highlighted. You can press the space bar to remove them. A screenshot of Bubbles is provided in Figure 3.

5. Conway's Life

The shortcut *M-x life* will start the Conway's Game of Life in a new GNU Emacs buffer. The population increases in the course of time, and the generation count is shown in the mode line. A screenshot of the cellular automation running inside GNU Emacs is provided in Figure 4.

6. Morse and NATO conversions

You can convert text to Morse code and vice versa by selecting the text in a buffer and using *M-x morse-region*. For example, the text 'morse code' gets converted to the following:

```
--/--/.-./.../. -.-/--/--/--.
```